

Helix OTA

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-07-09T00:00:00Z **Authority:**
OpenDesign TOKEN_SCHEMA (packages/contracts/src/design-systems/token-schema.ts) **Provenance:** brand colors derived from
clients/ota-manager/src/index.css

Category: Enterprise The Helix OTA control-plane brand: a calm, product-oriented enterprise surface for an over-the-air update system. Clean, dense, dashboard-first — built for operators watching fleets of devices, not for marketing pages.

Visual Theme & Atmosphere

Functional, precise, quietly confident. Content-first, chrome-second. The palette is the shadcn/ui “blue” family already shipping in the Helix OTA Manager: near-neutral slate surfaces with a single decisive brand blue as the one accent. No ornament, no gradients, no glassmorphism. Both light and dark are first-class because operators run this on wall dashboards and in dark NOC rooms alike.

Color Palette & Roles

All brand-identity colors below are the exact values from `clients/ota-manager/src/index.css`, converted from HSL to hex losslessly. Light value is listed first, then dark.

- **Background** (--bg): #FFFFFF / #020817 — from --background.
- **Surface** (--surface): #FFFFFF / #020817 — from --card.
- **Surface-warm** (--surface-warm): #F1F5F9 / #1E293B — from --secondary, the elevated-panel tone.
- **Foreground** (--fg): #020817 / #F8FAFC — from --foreground.
- **Muted** (--muted): #64748B / #94A3B8 — from --muted-foreground.
- **Border** (--border): #E2E8F0 / #1E293B — from --border.
- **Accent** (--accent): #2563EB / #3B82F6 — Helix brand blue, from --primary (Tailwind blue-600 light / blue-500 dark). ≤2 visible uses per screen.

- **Accent-on** (--accent-on): #F8FAFC / #0F172A — from --primary-foreground.
- **Danger** (--danger): #DC2626 / #7F1D1D — from --destructive.
- **Success / Warn** (--success / --warn): #16A34A / #EAB308 — schema A2 defaults; not defined in the canonical source.

Typography Rules

- **Display / Body:** Tailwind default sans stack (ui-sans-serif, system-ui, ...). ota-manager uses the font-sans utility with no custom brand face, so no proprietary display font is introduced.
- **Mono:** ui-monospace, "SF Mono", "JetBrains Mono", ... — schema default.
- **Scale (px):** 12 · 14 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 (OpenDesign default structure scale; ota-manager uses Tailwind's).
- **Line-height:** 1.5 body, 1.2 headings. Letter-spacing: -0.01em on display sizes.

Component Stylings

- **Buttons:** --radius-sm (8px, matching index.css --radius: 0.5rem). Primary = --accent fill, --accent-on label. Secondary = 1px --border, transparent fill.
- **Cards:** --surface, 1px --border, --radius-md (12px). Separation is via border, not shadow (bg and surface are equal in the source).
- **Inputs:** 1px --border, --radius-sm, --accent border/ring on focus (--focus-ring).
- **Links:** --accent, underline on hover.

Layout Principles

- 1200px max content width (--container-max), 24/16/12px gutters per breakpoint.
- Section rhythm 80/48/32px (desktop/tablet/phone).
- Dense dashboard first: whitespace as the primary separator; dividers only between unrelated sections.

Depth & Elevation

Three sanctioned levels, all schema A2 defaults: - **Flat** (`--elev-flat`): default. - **Ring** (`--elev-ring`): 1px hairline edge. - **Raised** (`--elev-raised`): 2px y-offset, 8px blur at 8% foreground. No neumorphism, no glassmorphism.

Light & Dark Themes

Both themes are first-class. `tokens.css` ships the LIGHT theme as the base `:root` (the full `TOKEN_SCHEMA` set) and re-binds only the color tokens that differ for DARK via three mechanisms so it works under any toggle: `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) (system)`, `:root[data-theme="dark"]` (explicit), and `.dark` (class — matching ota-manager's `@custom-variant dark (&:is(.dark *))`). Structural, spacing, radius, motion, and type tokens are theme-invariant and declared once. When vendored into ota-manager, these hex tokens map back onto its HSL `.light / :root` (dark default) variable pairs — that mapping is a later step and does not change this package.

Do's and Don'ts

- Use `--accent` for primary actions, links, focus, and one focal element.
- Preserve the schema token names exactly so cross-brand switching stays reliable.
- Keep both light and dark in sync when adding a color token.
- No raw hex outside the `:root` token block.
- No gradients, drop shadows on inputs, or more than three type sizes per screen.
- Do not invent brand colors — every color token traces to `index.css` or the OpenDesign schema defaults.

Agent Prompt Guide

- When in doubt, subtract. Fewer boxes, less chrome, more space.
- Use the brand blue sparingly — at most one hero accent and one CTA accent per screen.
- Do not introduce hex values outside this palette; if a request needs one, surface a warning comment and use the closest existing token.